

A different Zeitgeist

BitTorrent's Zeitgeist 2010 showcases the top 100 torrents that people searched for in the whole year. Surprisingly p()#n came in 9th while Inception was at the top

Freeconomy Community

The Freeconomy community's aim is to have a moneyless society and where everything is shared for free between members

Geek life

But how do we achieve it?

The concept is impressive but we're forced to ask the question – How do we do it? To answer this Fresco turns to technology, the only saving grace for mankind and a corner stone of The Venus Project. If we apply science and technology to redesign the existing social system we can achieve a humane civilization unlike anything in the past. All the mundane and boring tasks which humans perform on a day to day basis would be done by machines. Fresco says, "A resource-based economy overcomes scarcity by using renewable sources of energy, plus computerised automated manufacturing and inventory. It would design safe energy-efficient cities with advanced transportation systems, and would provide universal health care and more relevant education."

So, if all the work is done by machines then what do we do? Well we all can just kick back and relax or pursue something which we always wanted to do. So let's say for example you are a photography enthusiast and you want a camera, all you have to do is go to the nearest Access Centre and get the desired camera along with a manual on how to use it, you can use the camera as long as you like. Think of the Access Centre

Interview with Sujay Chakraborty

Everything said and done, we decided to do a real world check and interviewed Prof. Sujay Chakraborty who is an Associate Professor of Economics at Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi.

Q. What do you think of The Venus Project?

A. I think these are just words and I don't think they have any validity. All economies are resource-based economies. That's what we teach in economics. There's nothing new. It's all about getting resources and transferring them in order to allocate amongst people, so that's true for capitalist as well as socialist economies. You name it, they're all are resource-based.

Q. Can we provide abundance in the economy along with sustainability?

A. Everybody is saying it, Fresco is not the only one talking about sustainable development. There is a World Bank division on sustainable development which has about 50,000 economists driving the same point.

Interview with Jacque Fresco



The Venus Project vs. The Real world

So far everything seems like a wonderful dream from which you never want to wake up. Still unsure about a few aspects of the whole concept we decided to get the information straight from the horse's mouth, here's an excerpt from our interview with Jacque Fresco.

Q. What would be the motivational factor for humans if they don't have to work?

A. I am afraid of those who do things purely for money motivation. Motivational factors are now hunger, poverty or war. If this is not enough motivation I don't know what is. We feel that our proposals will generate a new incentive and motivational system. Human beings need challenges in order to evolve intellectually and maintain a high level of curiosity and a need to overcome shortages.

Q. How do you expect the common man not to call you a "hippie" when first presented with the idea of the Venus Project.

A. It is not a question if they take to it but if they understand it. This is why we want to make a major motion picture and have it translated into all languages in order to make this direction understandable to the general public. It doesn't make any difference what they call me. If few nations control most of the earth's resources we will always have territorial disputes, wars and mass uprisings.

as a public library, so everything from musical instruments to microscopes are available here. Everything is accessible to everyone without any money exchange – and that's the beauty of an RBE; no one's left out or discriminated.

Cities of the future

Based on the design of the Venus Project our future society would be much happier, we would live longer and wouldn't have to do things out of compulsion. The city of the future would be designed not only by architects but also sociologists, environmentalists, behavioural scientists and educators. It would be designed as a totally integrated system using renewable sources of energy.

One design concept is of having a circular city which would be surrounded by parks and gardens. It would be designed to operate with minimum expenditure of energy while obtaining highest standard of living. The city would use totally clean technology in harmony with the local ecology. Each home would be equipped

with a 3D flat-screen. If you desire an item, an order can be placed, and the item automatically delivered directly to your place of residence without a price tag. This includes whatever people need such as housing, clothing, education, health care, entertainment, etc.

Points to ponder

We would love to order an iPad from the sleek 3D display installed in our homes and have it delivered without having to pay for it! But it's too good to be true. It's a wild dream that Fresco has spun. The main flaw we see is that Fresco seems to underestimate the power that greed and sloth hold over us. Imagine a Cricket World Cup where every match ends in a tie, and all participating nations get their names on the cup, every 4 years! It's competition that makes us thrive and progress, and the utopian Venus Project may be able to do away with money, but greed runs a lot deeper than our wallets. Perhaps the first generation of people who live in an implementation of the Venus Project will be lazy moochers, but eventually learn to thrive. Who knows? We don't really expect to see this in any of our lifetimes anyway.

However, if you have suggestions for how the Venus Project can actually succeed, let us know. In fact, let them know as well – thevenusproject.com. 

